

The English Hub

AI-marked GCSE & IGCSE English revision, built for schools that take data protection seriously

Six exam boards. Marking turnaround under a minute. Children's Code by default. PDPPL Article 17 live in signup.

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The problem

Every English department in every secondary school in the GCC faces the same four problems at once:

1. Marking turnaround is too slow to be useful

A typical department of 80 Year 11 students writing fortnightly practice essays generates **160 essays a month**. Most departments are running **7 to 14 days behind** on marking turnaround. By the time feedback lands, the student has moved on and the learning moment is gone.

2. Feedback is necessarily light

No teacher has 90 minutes per essay. Practice-essay feedback is, by necessity, a few comments and a band — not the deep paragraph-by-paragraph analysis that actually moves a student from Grade 6 to Grade 8.

3. EAL students are penalised for the wrong reasons

Gulf-Arabic L1 students writing in English make different mistakes from L1 English speakers — different word order, different article use, different cohesion patterns. Conventional marking penalises these as basic errors when the underlying English thinking is often sound.

4. AI tools in education are a data-protection minefield

Most AI tutoring platforms train on student work, host data in the wrong jurisdiction, and have no Children's Code posture. A Qatari school DPO asking "where does our students' data live, who trains on it, and what's our Article 17 consent position?" gets a vague answer from most vendors.

What The English Hub does

Five things, end to end

- 1. AI essay marking against the actual mark scheme.** A Year 11 student submits a 600-word essay. Within about a minute they get a suggested band, AO-referenced feedback, and concrete revision suggestions. **All six exam boards** — AQA, Pearson Edexcel, OCR, Eduqas, WJEC, Cambridge IGCSE — with their specific assessment objectives baked into the prompts.
 - 2. Six exam boards' content, end to end.** Set texts, language papers, mock exam library, mark schemes, sample answers. KS3 (Pearson Edexcel iLowerSecondary), GCSE, IGCSE. A-level on roadmap for Q3 2026.
 - 3. EAL track with Gulf-Arabic L1 awareness.** A2 and B1 native bands live; B2/C1 in content authoring. Structural transfer errors handled fairly rather than penalised as basic mistakes.
 - 4. Parent + teacher dashboards.** Weekly parent progress emails (consent-gated). Teacher dashboards with class-level analytics, weak-area heatmaps, mock exam results.
 - 5. Children's Code by default.** Every under-18 account ships with high-privacy defaults enforced in code: personalised recommendations off, streak gamification off, behavioural nudges off, non-essential analytics off, public leaderboards off, geolocation off. **Tested in a strict suite covering ages 11 through 17.**
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Where we move the needle

We are deliberately not in the business of claiming "students improve their grade by X" without an outcome study to back it up. What we **can** evidence is that we move the four levers educational research consistently identifies as drivers of improvement in writing performance.

Lever 1 — Practice volume

The thing that most distinguishes a Grade 9 candidate from a Grade 5 candidate is the **number of essays they wrote, marked, and revised** in the year before the exam. Our platform makes that volume affordable for any student: a Year 11 can submit five essays in a week and get specific feedback on all five. No human department in the world can sustain that by hand.

Lever 2 — Feedback turnaround

Research on memory consolidation and feedback timing is clear: feedback that lands while the work is still mentally fresh is materially more useful than feedback that lands a fortnight later. **From 7–14 days to under one minute.**

Lever 3 — AO-specific feedback

Generic "good work, try harder" doesn't move a Grade 6 to a Grade 8. **AO-referenced** feedback that names the assessment objective the student missed, gives a specific example of how they missed it, and shows what to do instead — that does. Our feedback maps directly to the mark scheme the student is sitting.

Lever 4 — Mock exam practice under exam conditions

Timed practice papers under exam conditions are one of the most reliable predictors of exam performance. Our mock exam library covers every paper of every board.

What we don't yet claim

We are launch-stage and do not yet have a validated outcome study. Once the Founding cohort generates 12 months of data, that study is on the roadmap and the results — whatever they are — will be published openly. **We will never invent a grade-improvement statistic to win a sale.** If a competitor quotes you a specific number, ask to see the methodology.

Illustrative value calculation

This is **illustrative**. Real impact depends on your department size, your current marking practice, and your adoption depth. We show the working so you can swap your own numbers in.

Assumptions (change these to fit your school)

Assumption	Value	Source / why
Year 11 students writing fortnightly practice essays	80	Mid-size English department
Practice essays per student per month	2	Fortnightly cycle
Total practice essays / month	160	80×2
Teacher marking time per practice essay (light touch)	20 min	Common in busy departments
Total teacher marking time / month	53 hours	$160 \times 20 \div 60$
Fully-loaded teacher cost / hour (GCC mid-range)	£30	Substitute your number
Monthly value of reclaimed marking time	£1,600	$53 \times £30$
Annualised value of reclaimed marking time	£14,400	$£1,600 \times 9$ academic-year months

Compared to the Founding Schools fee

Item	Cost
Founding Schools annual deployment fee	£4,000 / year
Annualised value of reclaimed marking time (above)	£14,400
Plausible ROI for this single year group	~3.6×

What this calculation does NOT capture

- The **outcome** (grade) impact of more frequent, more specific feedback — which the research literature says is non-trivial, but which we are not yet in a position to quantify
- The **EAL fairness** dividend for Gulf-Arabic L1 students
- The **parent engagement** dividend (weekly parent emails, dashboard transparency)
- The **safeguarding** dividend (DSL flagged on safeguarding-relevant disclosures within 24 hours)
- The **PDPPL diligence cost** you save by not having to negotiate compliance with a less-prepared vendor

Important honesty note

If you replace any of the input assumptions, the maths comes out differently. We will not pretend we know your school better than you do. **You are welcome to ask us to walk through this calculation live in the discovery call with your own school's numbers in front of us.**

Why us specifically

1. Six exam boards, end to end. Most AI tutoring platforms cover "GCSE English" generically. We cover the actual mark schemes of all six UK exam boards Qatari British / American / Cambridge-curriculum schools sit.

2. PDPPL Article 17 cross-border consent is live in signup — as of 20 May 2026. Not on a brochure. In the product. Qatar-resident users see a named-destination consent banner before account creation. **Three v1.0 FINAL DPIAs** on file. **Article 16 permit application dossier** drafted and shelf-ready for NCGAA. **Separately-appointed DPO and DSL.**

3. Children's Code defaults in code, not in marketing. Standard 8 high-privacy defaults are off-by-default for under-18s and enforced via a strict test suite covering ages 11 through 17.

4. Zero AI training on student data. Contractually. Our DPA with Anthropic prohibits use of submitted essays for model training. Essays are transmitted under opaque identifiers — no directly-identifying account fields cross the AI inference boundary.

5. EU-region primary database (Frankfurt). UK backend (Azure UK South). US AI inference (Anthropic, zero retention). Full sub-processor list published at theenglishhub.app/data-processing.

6. Founder-led, launch-stage, transparent. We tell you what we don't have (NIA cert, ISO 27001, exam-board endorsement, granted Article 16 permit) so you know exactly what you're buying.

Talk to us

Three ways:

1. WhatsApp / phone the DSL line: +974 5187 9582 (Lauren Johnson, 24-hour acknowledgement SLA — yes, the founder's wife runs safeguarding; it's a small focused team)

2. Email the DPO inbox: dpo@theenglishhub.app (Calum Johnson, monitored daily)

3. Book a 30-minute discovery call: theenglishhub.app/for-schools (your school name, your role, the year group you'd pilot)

We are at the **Qatar Education Leadership Expo, Radisson Blu Doha, 23–24 May 2026** — find us at booth [number].

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